Building the OpenAI Story

Your FT article taken from zero knowledge to a two-minute answer you can defend against a human being. What every term means, what actually happened, why public markets move private valuations, and the one step beyond the article that turns a tech story into a Client Solutions story.

Doc 33 · Companion to doc 29 · Goldman Sachs 2027 EMEA London · Asset Management, Client Solutions Group · Prepared 4 November 2026

CONTENTS

1. **The verdict.** Is this the right story? Yes, with one condition — and the condition is the whole answer
2. **Every word in the article, explained.** Funding rounds, valuations, first close, S-1, hyperscalers, corrections. Assume nothing
3. **What actually happened,** as a sequence rather than a news story
4. **The mechanism:** four reasons a public sell-off repriced a private company
5. **The bridge:** five routes by which this reaches a pension fund — this is where you win
6. **Your opinion,** three defensible versions with the test that proves you are not reciting
7. **The answer,** content section and full two minutes, annotated
8. **Round two:** the nine follow-ups a human will ask, with answers
9. **How to build this in two days,** what to re-verify, and the honesty rules

Two notes before you start. First, sourcing: facts marked FT come from the article you sent me, dated 31 October 2026. Facts marked MEDIUM come from my own research today and are from reputable secondary reporting I could not cross-check against primary filings. Re-verify anything you plan to say out loud, because this story is moving fast.

Second, and worth saying plainly: **I am made by Anthropic, one of the companies in this story.** Everything below about Anthropic's listing comes from the same public research as everything else — I have no inside knowledge of it, and I have labelled its confidence exactly as I would for any other company. Treat my account of it with the same scepticism you should apply to the rest.

PART 1

The verdict

1 Is this a good story? Yes, with one condition

Straight answer first, then the reasoning.

VERDICT

Use it — but not in the shape the article gives you. As written, this is a venture capital funding story. Venture capital is not what Client Solutions Group does, and a pension trustee does not care what OpenAI's valuation is. The article's own closing line gets you to the halfway point: "this shows how developments in public markets can trickle down into private fundraising." That is correct, and it is the version every other candidate who reads this will give. **The version that wins goes one step further: into the portfolios of the institutions you would actually be serving.**

Why it is a strong choice

- **It is genuinely current.** The article is from 31 October; the Nasdaq 100 entered a correction on 2 November. MEDIUM "Recent" is doing work in the prompt and this is four days old.
- **It contains a real mechanism,** not just an event. Public markets repricing private assets is a chain you can explain, which is exactly what the question tests.
- **A sovereign wealth fund is in the middle of it.** The UAE consortium including MGX is expected to be the largest participant in the round. FT Sovereign wealth funds are one of your five client types. That is not a stretch; it is in the article.
- **It connects to the story you have already built.** Doc 29's AI data-centre debt chain is the second half of this one. If equity capital for AI becomes harder and more expensive, more of the buildout has to be funded with debt — and that debt ends up in institutional portfolios. Having both halves gives you an answer almost nobody will have.
- **You found it yourself and you are curious about it.** That is worth more than a better topic you are bored by.

The three risks, honestly

Risk	How real it is, and what to do
AI is the most crowded topic available	Real. Many candidates will talk about AI. *But* almost all of them will talk about AI as a technology or a bubble. Very few will talk about the **cost of capital for AI**, and essentially none will follow it into institutional portfolios. Your differentiation is the angle, not the topic.
It is a tech and venture story, not an asset management one	Real as written, and fatal if you leave it there. Fixed entirely by Part 5. The bridge has to be in the answer, not implied.
You might sound like you read one article	Your stated weakness, so take it seriously. The protection is understanding the *mechanism* well enough to explain it without the article's words. If you can draw the chain on paper from memory, you are safe. If you can only recite the figures, you are not.

> THE REFRAME, IN ONE LINE
>
> Stop thinking of this as "OpenAI cut its funding round." Start thinking of it as **"the cost of capital for the AI buildout just repriced, and institutional investors are on the other side of that trade whether they chose to be or not."** Same facts. Completely different altitude. The first is news; the second is an argument.

PART 2

Every word, explained

2 The glossary you need to read the article properly

You said you did not understand much of it. That is not a failure of intelligence; the article assumes about fifteen pieces of vocabulary. Here they all are. Read this once and the article becomes transparent.

HOW COMPANIES RAISE MONEY

Private company	A company whose shares are not traded on a stock exchange. You cannot buy OpenAI shares on your phone. To invest you must be invited into a funding round, which in practice means being a large institution or a very wealthy individual.

Funding round	The company sells new shares to a chosen group of investors in exchange for cash. The cash goes *into the company* to be spent. In exchange, investors own a slice of it.
Valuation	The agreed price tag for the whole company in that round. Crucially, it is **not a market price**. It is a number negotiated between the company and a handful of investors. If OpenAI sells $20bn of new shares for roughly 1.6% of the company, that implies a $1.25tn valuation. The valuation is *derived* from the deal, not observed in a market.
Allocation	How much of the round a given investor is permitted or chooses to take. "Investors lowered their allocations" means they committed less money than they had indicated. That is the specific thing that forced the target down.
First close	Rounds this large do not complete in one day. The company sets a deadline, collects whatever commitments exist by then, and closes that tranche — the "first close" — then keeps raising. The article says the first close is expected to bring in less than $20bn. FT
Retail offering	A separate opportunity for wealthy individuals, rather than institutions, to buy in at the same price. Used here to top the round up toward the target after institutions pulled back.
IPO	Initial Public Offering. The company lists its shares on a stock exchange so anyone can buy and sell them. After this, the price is set by a market every second rather than negotiated once a year.
S-1	The registration document a US company files with the SEC before listing. It contains the financials, the risks and the business description. Anthropic publicly filed its S-1 on 26 October 2026, intending to list on Nasdaq. MEDIUM A public S-1 means a listing is weeks away, not months.
Roadshow	The weeks before a listing when management presents to institutional investors to build demand and discover what price the market will bear.

WHO THE INVESTORS ARE

Venture capital firm	A fund that invests in private companies on behalf of its own investors. Sequoia, Founders Fund, Andreessen Horowitz and Coatue are all named in the article. FT Importantly, *their* money largely comes from pensions, endowments and sovereign funds — which is the first hint of where this story is going.
MGX	An Abu Dhabi state-backed AI investment vehicle, anchored by Mubadala and G42. It closed a roughly $49bn fund in mid-2026 and co-led OpenAI's $122bn raise in March. MEDIUM **This is a sovereign wealth vehicle — client type 3 from doc 32.**
SoftBank	A Japanese holding company and technology investor, historically a very large and very aggressive backer of private tech companies.

WHAT MOVED IN PUBLIC MARKETS

Hyperscaler	The handful of enormous cloud computing companies — Amazon, Microsoft, Google, Meta — that build and operate the data centres everyone else rents. They are the ones actually spending the money on AI infrastructure.
Nasdaq 100	An index of the hundred largest non-financial companies listed on the Nasdaq exchange. Heavily weighted toward technology, so it is the standard shorthand for "how is the tech trade doing."

Correction	A fall of 10% or more from a recent peak. The Nasdaq 100 closed at 27,989.82 on 2 November, more than 10% below its 6 October peak, meeting that threshold — its third correction of 2026, and it remains up about 11% for the year. MEDIUM That last clause matters: this is a sharp pullback inside an up year, not a crash.
Free cash flow	Cash left over after a company has paid its running costs *and* its capital spending. The reason it matters here: if you spend enormous sums building data centres, free cash flow falls even when profits look fine. Amazon reportedly showed a jump in negative free cash flow. MEDIUM Investors read that as "the spending is real and the return is not here yet."
Capital expenditure	Money spent on physical assets — buildings, chips, power. BlackRock puts hyperscaler capex at roughly $650bn over the past year, up from about $360bn the year before, with incremental margins falling to around 28% from 40%. MEDIUM **That margin line is the single most important number in this whole story** and Part 4 explains why.
Compute agreements	Contracts to rent computing power. OpenAI does not own most of the machines it runs on; it signs long-term agreements for capacity. This is a large fixed commitment, which is why it needs so much cash.

PART 3

What actually happened

3 The sequence, stripped of news language

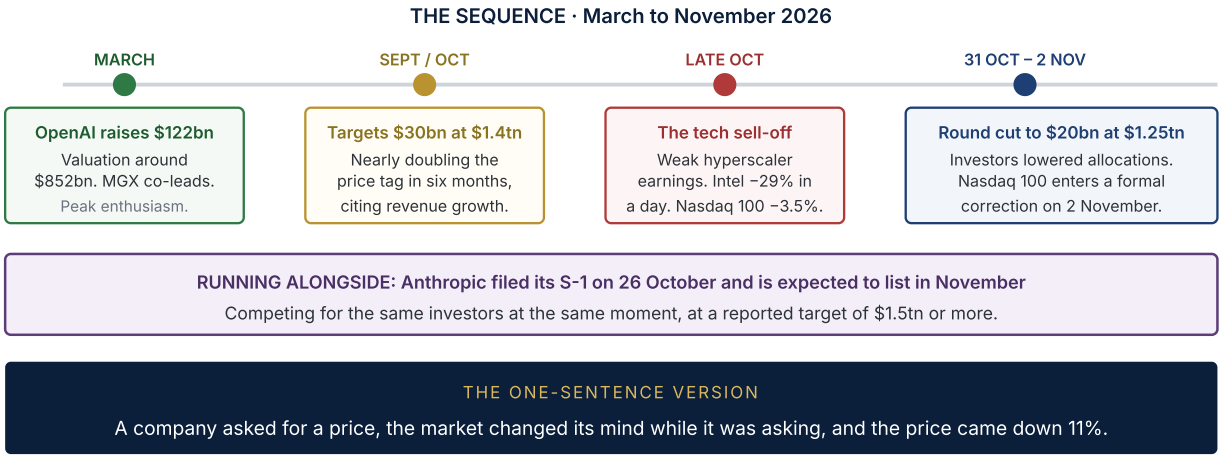


Figure 1 — The sequence. March and October figures from the FT article; the correction and Intel move from my research. MEDIUM on the latter

The three causes, separated

The article gives you three. Keeping them distinct is what makes you sound analytical rather than descriptive.

1. **Sentiment and valuation.** Public tech fell hard, so the price investors were willing to pay for anything AI-shaped fell with it.
2. **Competition for the same capital.** Anthropic is listing imminently, absorbing both money and attention from the same investor base. The article says some backers are waiting to see Anthropic's pricing before committing further. FT

3. **Substitution.** This one is implied rather than stated, and spotting it is a mark of real thinking: if you can shortly buy a comparable AI company on a public exchange, with daily liquidity and audited accounts, why pay a negotiated price for an illiquid private stake? **An imminent IPO creates a liquid alternative to a private round, and that alone compresses private valuations.** MY INFERENCE

PART 4

The mechanism

4 Why a public sell-off reprices a private company

This is the core of the answer and the thing the article asserts but does not explain. If you understand these four links, you can talk about this with anyone.

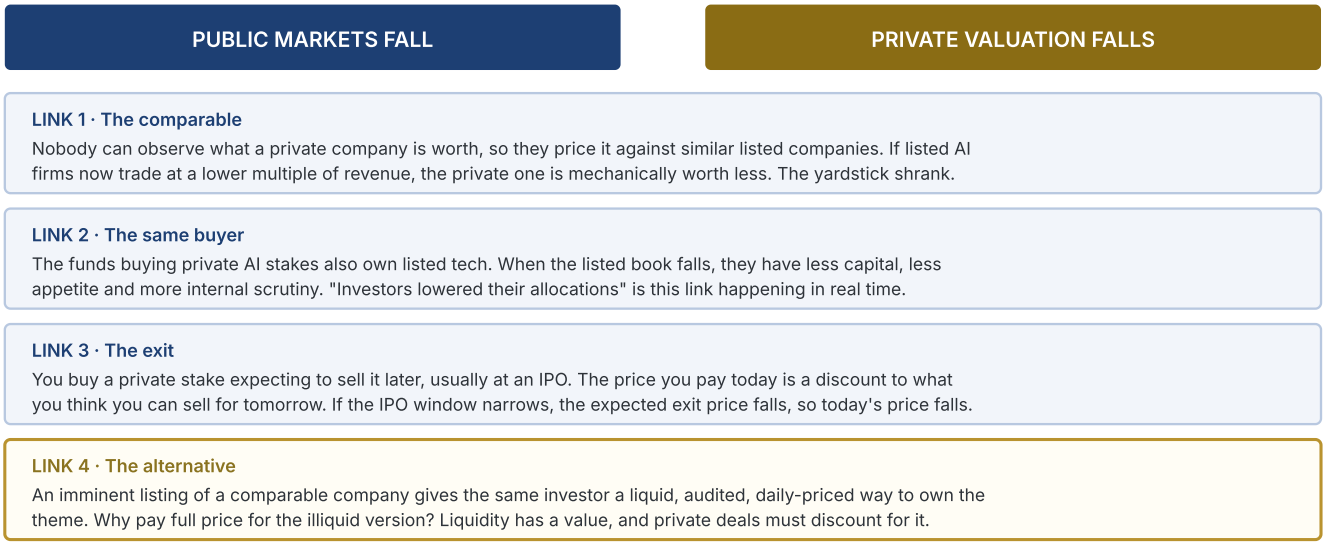


Figure 2 — The four links. Links 1 to 3 are standard market mechanics; link 4 is my reading of why Anthropic's listing specifically matters here. MINE on link 4

And underneath all four, the thing that actually changed

Here is the sentence that will separate you from everybody else who reads this article. The question investors started asking in late October was not "is AI important?" It was **"what is the return on the capital being spent?"**

BlackRock's figures give you the arithmetic: hyperscaler capital spending of roughly **$650bn over the past year, up from about $360bn**, while incremental margins fell to around **28% from 40%**. MEDIUM Read those two together and the worry is obvious without any jargon: *spending almost doubled and the profit earned on each extra pound of revenue got worse.* That is the entire bear case in one line, and it explains why Amazon's negative free cash flow mattered more than its profit figure.

> **THINK LIKE A CAPITAL ALLOCATOR**
>
> Everything in this story is one question: **what does capital cost, and what does it earn?** When investors believed AI spending would earn a high return, capital was cheap and abundant for anyone AI-shaped — hence a company nearly doubling its price tag in six months. When they started doubting the return, capital got more expensive, and the first place that shows up is the company with the weakest negotiating position in the room. OpenAI did not get worse in October. The price of money did.

PART 5

The bridge

5 Five routes from this article to a pension fund

This section is the answer. Everything before it is background; this is where a tech story becomes a Client Solutions story. You do not need all five. You need one, explained properly, and ideally a second mentioned in a clause.

Route 1 — A sovereign wealth fund is in the deal STRONGEST AND SIMPLEST

The article tells you the largest participant is expected to be a UAE consortium including MGX. FT MGX is a state-backed vehicle anchored by Mubadala and G42 which closed a roughly $49bn fund in mid-2026 and co-led the March round. MEDIUM

So this is not a story happening *to* tech companies and venture capitalists. A sovereign wealth fund — one of the client types this division serves — is writing the cheque. And note the structure the article describes: as part of the deal, OpenAI gets an option to lease newly developed computing power in the region. FT That is a sovereign fund buying industrial policy as much as a financial return, which is exactly the kind of non-financial objective that makes sovereign clients different and is in doc 32.

Route 2 — The denominator effect MOST TECHNICAL, BEST PAYOFF

This one earns you the most credit per sentence because it is a real institutional mechanic that students essentially never know. Here it is from zero.

The problem. Listed shares are priced every second. Private holdings are not — they are valued periodically by appraisal, and those valuations move slowly. So when public markets fall sharply, the public half of a portfolio drops immediately and the private half does not move for months.

The arithmetic. Take a pension fund with £10bn, of which £2bn is in private funds. Private allocation = 20%, which happens to be its policy limit. Public equities now fall 20%. The private holdings are still marked at £2bn because nobody has revalued them. The portfolio is now £8.4bn, and the private allocation is **£2bn / £8.4bn ≈ 23.8%**.
MEDIUM — standard worked example from industry sources

The consequence. The fund is now over its limit, *having done nothing and having made no decision*. The denominator shrank. It may be forced to stop making new private commitments, or in an extreme case to sell private stakes at a discount on the secondary market. Industry guidance explicitly warns that private marks lag public ones considerably, so rebalancing gets triggered without full knowledge of what the private assets are really worth. MEDIUM

Why it connects: if private AI valuations are now being cut — which is precisely what this article reports happening to OpenAI — then institutional investors holding private AI stakes are about to see those marks come down with a lag. The write-downs arrive a quarter or two after the public fall, by which point the public market may have recovered. That timing mismatch is a genuine governance problem for an allocator, and solving it is the kind of thing a solutions business exists for.

Route 3 — Equity gets harder, so the burden shifts to debt LINKS TO YOUR DOC 29 STORY

This is the route that makes your two stories into one, and it is the most sophisticated thing you could say.

1. The AI buildout needs an enormous amount of capital, and the spending is contracted and ongoing. Compute agreements do not pause because the share price fell.
2. If equity capital becomes scarcer and more expensive — which is exactly what this article documents — the money has to come from somewhere else.

3. It comes from debt. Morgan Stanley's estimate is that private credit could supply more than half of a roughly $1.5tn data-centre buildout through 2028; Bloomberg's is that there is already more than $500bn of AI data-centre debt outstanding, about $200bn of it in private credit funds. MEDIUM
4. And private credit funds are financed by pension schemes, insurers and sovereign funds. Which is to say: **as equity funding tightens, more of the risk migrates to the kind of investor your division serves, and it arrives labelled as investment-grade credit rather than as a bet on AI.**

Corroboration you can cite: BlackRock has said it is watching credit spreads on hyperscaler and AI-linked debt as a leading indicator. MEDIUM That tells you the credit channel is where professionals are actually looking, not the equity headlines.

Route 4 — The same risk, held twice, invisibly

A trustee who has deliberately capped technology exposure in the equity book can hold the same underlying risk again on the credit side, where it is labelled investment-grade private credit and carries no daily price. Mercer has been explicitly telling trustees this year to assess AI concentration across the *whole* portfolio rather than just equities. MEDIUM The live problem is not forecasting AI; it is being able to see your own exposure.

Route 5 — What it does to the asset manager's own revenue

Worth having in reserve if you are asked "what does this mean for us?" From doc 32: a fall in markets reduces assets under supervision, and therefore fees, mechanically. But private assets do not mark down immediately — so fee income on private mandates is far more stable through a public sell-off than fee income on listed equity mandates. That is one of several reasons an asset manager wants a larger share of its assets in alternatives. Goldman's alternatives assets under supervision were $491bn as at 30 September 2026, up 26% in a year. PRIMARY

PART 6

Your opinion

6 Three defensible views, each with its falsifier

From doc 29: an opinion is a claim that could turn out to be wrong, with a reason attached, and a condition under which you would admit it. Pick **one**. Do not stack them.

> VIEW A — THE MISPRICING TEMPLATE · RECOMMENDED, MOST DEFENSIBLE
>
> "My view is that the headline is being read as a story about AI sentiment, and I think it is more interesting as a story about the cost of capital. Nothing about OpenAI changed between September and October. What changed was the price investors are willing to pay for anything funded by that pool of capital, and that repricing happens to the most capital-hungry borrower first. What would tell me I am wrong is the Anthropic listing. If it prices strongly and trades well, then this was a sentiment wobble and capital comes straight back. If it prices at the low end or breaks, then the repricing is real and it will show up next in the credit markets rather than in equities."

VIEW B — THE SECOND-ORDER TEMPLATE · STRONGEST BRIDGE TO YOUR DIVISION

"The part I find most interesting is not the valuation, because I have no idea what OpenAI is worth and nor does anybody else. It is what happens to the funding mix. The spending commitments do not pause when equity gets expensive, so the capital has to come from somewhere, and the obvious somewhere is private credit. Morgan Stanley's estimate is that private credit could fund more than half of the data-centre buildout. So the more difficult equity becomes, the more of this risk ends up in pension and insurance portfolios, arriving as investment-grade credit rather than as an AI position. What would change my mind is the spread data. If hyperscaler and AI-linked credit spreads stay tight through this, the debt market disagrees with the equity market, and I would want to know which one is right."

VIEW C — THE DURABILITY TEMPLATE · BOLDEST, USE ONLY IF CONFIDENT

"I think this is being read as cyclical and it may be structural. The specific thing that changed is that investors started asking about return on capital rather than about capability. BlackRock's numbers have hyperscaler capex at around $650bn against roughly $360bn the year before, with incremental margins down to about 28% from 40%. Once allocators start underwriting a spend on its margin rather than on its story, that is a change in how the whole theme is financed, not a bad week. What would prove me wrong is the next earnings season: if the big spenders show the margin stabilising, the question goes away and the capital returns."

WHAT A REVIEWER WILL MARK AS A 1

"OpenAI has cut its funding round from $30 billion to $20 billion because of the AI sell-off, which shows that public markets affect private markets. I think it will be interesting to see what happens with the Anthropic IPO and whether AI is a bubble."

Accurate, fluent, and worth nothing. Every thought in it came from the article, there is no mechanism, no institutional client appears anywhere, and it ends on the forbidden phrase.

PART 7

The answer

7 Content section and full two minutes, annotated

Roughly 300 words, about 110 seconds spoken. **Do not memorise the words.** Memorise the four beats and the three figures, and generate the sentences live, differently each time. That is what stops it sounding recited.

BEAT 1 — THE CONTENT SECTION, ~18 SECONDS

Thanks for taking the time to watch this. The story I have been following is OpenAI cutting its funding round, from thirty billion dollars at a one point four trillion valuation down to about twenty billion at one point two five trillion, in the space of a month. What interests me is not really the valuation. It is that nothing about the company changed in that month, so what actually repriced was the cost of capital, and I want to talk about where that lands, because a lot of it lands with institutional investors.

BEAT 2 — THE MECHANISM, ~33 SECONDS

The chain runs roughly like this. A private company has no market price, so it gets valued against comparable listed companies. Listed tech sold off hard in late October, partly on hyperscaler earnings, and the Nasdaq 100 went into a correction. So the yardstick shrank. On top of that the same investors who buy private AI stakes also own the listed version, so when that book falls they have less appetite and more internal scrutiny, and you see that directly in the reporting, where investors lowered their allocations. And then Anthropic is listing within weeks, which gives those same investors a liquid, audited way to own the theme instead of an illiquid one. Three separate pressures, all pushing the same way.

BEAT 3 — THE BRIDGE TO INSTITUTIONAL CLIENTS, ~32 SECONDS

What makes it relevant to this division is where the money is coming from and where it goes next. The largest participant in the round is expected to be a UAE consortium including MGX, which is a sovereign wealth vehicle, so this is institutional capital, not just venture capital. And the second-order effect matters more. The spending commitments do not pause because the share price fell, so if equity gets more expensive, more of the buildout has to be funded with debt. Morgan Stanley's estimate is that private credit could supply over half of it. Private credit funds are financed by pensions and insurers, so the risk migrates toward exactly the clients this business serves, and it arrives labelled as investment-grade credit rather than as an AI position.

BEAT 4 — THE VIEW AND THE TEST, ~27 SECONDS

So my own view is that this is being read as a story about AI sentiment and it is more usefully read as a story about the cost of capital, and the interesting question is which market is right, because the equity market has clearly repriced and I am not sure the credit market has. The thing I would watch is two-fold. First, how the Anthropic listing actually prices, because that is a real market test rather than a negotiated one. And second, spreads on hyperscaler and AI-linked debt, because if those stay tight while equities fall, then the credit market disagrees, and one of them is going to be wrong.

What each move is doing

Move	Why it is there
Two figures in the first 15 seconds	Lands concreteness inside the attention gate, and both numbers come straight from the article so you can defend them.
"Nothing about the company changed"	The pivot from news to analysis, and it arrives at about second twelve. This is the sentence that signals you are not summarising.
"Where that lands, because a lot of it lands with institutional investors"	Names the destination without explaining it. The reviewer now knows this is going somewhere relevant to them, which buys the remaining hundred seconds.
"The chain runs roughly like this"	Announces structure. Signals premeditation, which is what you want when the field is improvising.
"Three separate pressures, all pushing the same way"	The compression line. One phrase that holds the whole mechanism. Every good answer has one.
The MGX sentence	The bridge, and it is bulletproof because it comes from the article itself rather than from a stretch. A sovereign wealth fund is a client of this division.
"The spending commitments do not pause"	The second-order move. This is the single most impressive sentence in the answer because it is a consequence nobody told you.
"I am not sure the credit market has"	Calibrated confidence. Stating the limit of what you know is a status move in a student, not a weakness.
Two falsifiers at the end	Ends on the highest-status content in the answer. "Here is what would settle this" is the signature of someone who actually thinks.

PART 8

Round two

8 The nine follow-ups a human will ask

You said you want to hold this in a live conversation, not just a recording. Here are the questions that will come, with what to say — and, where the honest answer is "I don't know," how to say that well.

They ask	You say
"Do you think OpenAI is worth $1.25 trillion?"	Don't take the bait. "I genuinely have no view on that, because I cannot see the revenue or the contract terms and almost nobody outside the company can. What I do have a view on is that the number moved 11% in a month without the company changing, which tells you it is a negotiated price rather than a market one." Refusing a question you cannot answer, and explaining why, is stronger than guessing.
"Is this an AI bubble?"	"I don't know, and I'd be suspicious of a student who claimed to. What I'd say is that the question investors started asking in October was narrower than that. It was about return on capital — the capex nearly doubled while incremental margins fell — and you can worry about that without believing the whole thing is a bubble."
"Why should a pension fund care?"	Your beat 3. Three sentences: a sovereign fund is the largest participant; the funding burden is shifting from equity to private credit; private credit is financed by pensions and insurers, so the exposure arrives labelled as credit.
"What's the counter-argument?"	Give it generously. "The bear case gets over-told. These are real assets with contracted cash flows, the senior tranches are genuinely senior, and a private credit fund with locked-up capital is arguably a safer home for illiquid credit than a bank funded overnight. Also the Nasdaq 100 is still up about 11% on the year — this is a sharp pullback inside an up year, not a crash."
"What's the denominator effect?"	If you raised it, be ready. Give the £10bn / £2bn worked example from Part 5. Thirty seconds, no jargon, and it lands hard because almost no candidate can do it.
"What would you actually do about it if you were advising a client?"	Stay modest and operational — grand answers fail here. "Look through to the underlying driver rather than the asset-class label, so you can see AI exposure in the credit book and the equity book together. And be clear with the board in advance about the lag on private marks, so a write-down two quarters from now isn't a surprise."
"Why does Anthropic's IPO matter to OpenAI's private round?"	Three reasons, and the third is the good one: it absorbs the same capital; it sets a visible price for a comparable business; and it gives investors a liquid alternative, so the private round has to offer a discount for illiquidity that it didn't have to offer before.
"How are you following this?"	Honest and specific beats a list. Name the FT piece and one or two things you went and read because of it. Then demonstrate rather than list.
"What happened with the figures since?"	If you don't know, say so and say when you last checked. "As of the fourth of November it was X; I haven't checked since this morning." Nobody expects live data. Everybody notices a stale number stated confidently.

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING IN THIS DOCUMENT

You will be tempted, in round two, to defend a position you do not really hold because you said it on camera. **Don't.** "That's a fair challenge — I hadn't weighted that properly" is a genuinely good answer and interviewers rate it highly, because the job involves being told things by clients and portfolio managers who know more than you. Being coachable is a selected-for trait in a client-facing seat. Stubbornness is not.

PART 9

9 Two days from here to fluent

When	Do	Why
Day 1, 30 min	Read Part 2 of this document, then re-read your FT article. Nothing else.	The article will be transparent the second time. That feeling is what comprehension is; chase it before adding anything new.
Day 1, 30 min	Write the four links from Part 4 on one sheet of paper, with the article closed and this document closed.	If you cannot write the chain from memory, you have not got it yet. This is the exact exercise that stops you reciting.
Day 1, 30 min	Pick *one* bridge from Part 5 and learn it properly. Route 2 or Route 3.	One bridge explained well beats three mentioned.
Day 2, 30 min	Re-verify every figure. Check the Nasdaq level, whether Anthropic has priced, and whether OpenAI's round has closed.	This story is moving weekly. A stale figure stated confidently is the one unrecoverable error.
Day 2, 20 min	Pick one view from Part 6 and write your falsifier in your own words.	The falsifier is the highest-value sentence in the answer and it cannot be improvised.
Day 2, 45 min	Film it twelve to fifteen times, deliberately changing the words while keeping the four beats and three figures fixed.	This, not more reading, is what makes it sound like you rather than like the FT.
Day 2, 15 min	Explain beat 2 out loud to someone with no finance knowledge.	If they can repeat the chain back, you own it. If you reach for a phrase you cannot explain, you borrowed it.

What to read, in order

1. Your FT article again, after Part 2.
2. The FT's own related pieces, which were listed at the bottom of your article and are directly on point: *The limits of hedging the AI boom*, *A chill wind in the AI credit market*, and Martin Wolf's *Are we ready for an AI bust?* The credit one is the most useful for your bridge.
3. Anything on hyperscaler capital expenditure and free cash flow from the Q3 earnings round.
4. A Bank of England *Financial Stability Report* section on private credit, for the counter-argument and the regulator's framing.

The honesty rules, which matter more than the content

- **Re-verify before you record.** The Nasdaq level, the Anthropic listing status, whether OpenAI's round closed and at what number. All three could change this week.
- **Attribute every figure.** "The FT reported", "Morgan Stanley's estimate is", "BlackRock's figures have". Attribution is free insurance and it signals you know where knowledge comes from.
- **Never invent a number.** If you cannot verify it, say the shape: "over half a trillion" rather than a precise total.
- **Do not claim to have read something you skimmed.** One article genuinely understood beats five name-dropped, and the follow-up question will find you out.
- **Say "I don't know" where it is true.** On this story in particular — whether it is a bubble, what OpenAI is worth — the honest answer is better than the confident one, and reviewers can tell the difference.

> **ONE LINE TO TAKE AWAY**
>
> The article is about a company. Your answer is about the price of money, who is paying it, and where the risk ends up. Make that shift and you are no longer a student summarising the FT — you are someone describing a capital market to a person who works in one.

Sourcing and confidence

From your article FT, 31 October 2026, George Hammond and Amelia Pollard: the $30bn / $1.4tn target, the cut to roughly $20bn / $1.25tn, the earlier $852bn valuation, the $122bn March raise, the Friday Nasdaq 100 fall of 3.5%, investors lowering allocations, the first close expected below $20bn, the UAE consortium including MGX as expected largest participant and the regional compute lease option, the named venture firms and SoftBank, the planned retail offering, and Anthropic listing next month at a reported $1.5tn or more.

Medium — my research on 4 November 2026, from secondary reporting I could not cross-check against primary sources. The Nasdaq 100 entering a correction on 2 November at 27,989.82, more than 10% below its 6 October peak while still up about 11% for the year; Intel's fall of roughly 29% on 30 October; Amazon's negative free cash flow; Alphabet's market value fall; BlackRock's hyperscaler capex figures of about $650bn against roughly $360bn and incremental margins of about 28% against 40%; BlackRock watching AI-linked credit spreads; Anthropic's S-1 filing on 26 October, the Nasdaq ticker ANT, reported listing in the week of 16 November and target valuations of $1.5tn to $2tn with its last confirmed private valuation of $965bn; MGX's roughly $49bn fund close and its anchoring by Mubadala and G42; Morgan Stanley's and Bloomberg's data-centre debt estimates; Mercer's guidance to trustees; and the denominator effect worked example.

Primary. Goldman's alternatives assets under supervision of $491bn at 30 September 2026, up 26%, from the September 2026 Form 10-Q.

Mine, labelled in the text. The substitution argument (link 4), the reframe from valuation to cost of capital, the five bridge routes, the three opinion constructions and the drafted answer.

Disclosure. I am made by Anthropic, which appears in this story. I have no non-public information about its listing and have treated it as I would any other company, with the same confidence labels.